Sara Truesdale

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Citizenship: United States of America
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Education

Ph.D., Economics, University of Colorado Boulder 2027 (expected)

M.A., Economics, University of Colorado Boulder 2024

M.A., Economics, University of Colorado Denver 2022

M.S., Electrical Engineering, Lehigh University 2010

B.S., Electrical Engineering, Lehigh University 2008

Research Interests

Labor economics, public economics, applied microeconomics

Job Market Paper

"Children and Household Burden: The Influence of Pre-Birth Couple Norms"
The arrival of a first child is a significant shock to a couple's household labor arrangement. How does this shock affect couples differently depending on their pre-birth division of housework, and what are the implications for individuals' well-being? Using rich longitudinal data from the Household, Income and Labour Dynamics in Australia Survey, I categorize childless couples based on their division of housework before having children and estimate their differential responses to the arrival of their first child. I find a pattern of a larger increase in household work for women who did a smaller share before the birth. On average, regardless of pre-birth division of household labor, couples converge toward an arrangement where the female partner does the majority of the household labor after the first birth. Women from egalitarian couples experience the biggest increase in happiness post-birth, but the biggest decline in relationship satisfaction.

Working Papers

"Childhood Immigrant Neighbors and Integration" with Brian Duncan and Hani Mansour
Does childhood contact with immigrants increase natives' willingness to integrate with them as adults? We answer this question using the sequential enumeration order of the 1930 U.S. Census, which lets us identify native boys who happened to live immediately next door to a foreign-born child. Conditional on county fixed effects and the spatial distribution of immigrant and native households along a given street, the nativity of the specific next-door neighbor is plausibly random. We find that boys who lived next to a foreign-born child were significantly more likely to marry a foreign-born spouse a decade later. The effect is driven by exposure to immigrant boys rather than girls, and is more than three times larger for exposure between ages 8–12 than for ages 13–17, consistent with a mechanism operating through childhood play and friendship rather

than marriage-market access. These findings suggest that the assimilation of immigrants depends not only on their own efforts to integrate, but also on natives' willingness to welcome them.

Work in Progress

"The Effect of Title IX-induced Adjustment on Girls' Sports Involvement on Family Formation"

"Labor Market Effects of Postpartum Medicaid Expansion" with Megan Rice

"Stay-at-Home-Fatherhood and Lifetime Household Income"

Research Experience

Research Assistant, University of Colorado Boulder - Department of Economics 2024-2026
Prof. Brian Cadena, Prof. Terra McKinnish

Research Assistant, University of Colorado Boulder - Institute of Behavioral Science 2023
Prof. Tania Barnham

Research Assistant, University of Colorado Denver - Department of Economics 2020-2022
Prof. Brian Duncan, Prof. Hani Mansour, Prof. Maulik Jagnani

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Intermediate Microeconomic Theory Spring 2026
University of Colorado Boulder

Instructor, Master's in Economics Math Camp: Probability and Statistics Summer 2026
University of Colorado Denver

Teaching Assistant, Financial Literacy Fall 2026
University of Colorado Boulder

Teaching Assistant, Principles of Macroeconomics Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025
University of Colorado Boulder

Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics Fall 2022, Fall 2025
University of Colorado Boulder

Work Experience

Executive Relationship Manager, ADP Jan 2017–Nov 2019

- Developed strategic relationship with client executives to maximize value of product and services

Technical Solutions Analyst, Cornerstone OnDemand April 2013–Jan 2017

- Investigated and validated reported defects, liaised between build engineers and clients to find timely resolutions for all stakeholders

Honors, Awards, and Grants

Graduate Award for Public Policy Research	2026
Sieglinde Talbott Haller Award, CU Boulder Department of Economics	2025
Leslie Whittington Endowed Fellowship for Excellence in Economics	2023, 2024

Conference Presentations and Invited Talks

2026: CSQIEP Mentoring Conference, CU Population Center (poster, scheduled), United States Air Force Academy (scheduled)

Skills

Software: Stata, Python, SAS, LaTeX, Matlab

References

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